Card Rewards Dataset — India Top 5 Issuers + Amex + International

Prepared 5 Nov 2026 for the Voucher Rail agent. Purpose: the numbers the agent shows a buyer when it picks the card and route for a voucher. Every row carries a source grade; the agent must re-check the official page before displaying a number to a user.

Source grades

- **OFFICIAL** — bank MITC / terms PDF / product page read directly.
- **SECONDARY** — card-review site dated Oct–Nov 2026 citing bank terms. Use for the build; confirm on the official page before going live.
- **PENDING** — not found yet.

How % is computed: `points per spend unit ÷ spend unit × best official point value`. Example: Infinia 5 RP per ₹150 × ₹1 = 3.33%. "Cashback" cards are already in %.

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1. MCC reference (what the agent matches against)

MCCs are set by the network and acquirer; banks state many as "best effort". A voucher bought on a bank portal is coded by the portal's merchant, not the brand, so the agent records the MCC seen on the user's statement after the first purchase.

Category	MCCs	Typical treatment in India (2026)
Wallet / stored value load	6540, 6541	No rewards on all five banks; fees above thresholds (section 4)
Rent	6513	No rewards (HDFC since 1 Jan 2023); fee 1% (HDFC, Axis) or ₹199 (SBI)
Fuel	5541, 5542, 5983, 5172	Mostly no rewards; surcharge waiver only; Axis 1% fee ≥ ₹50k/cycle

Category	MCCs	Typical treatment in India (2026)
Utilities	4900	Capped or excluded; HDFC 2,000 RP/month cap; fees above thresholds
Telecom / cable	4814, 4899	HDFC 2,000 RP/month cap; Axis treats as utility
Insurance	6300	HDFC caps: Infinia 10,000 / DCB 5,000 / others 2,000 RP per month
Education	8211, 8220, 8241, 8244, 8249, 8299	1% fee via third-party apps (HDFC, SBI, Axis); HDFC: no points via apps
Government / tax	9311, 9399, 9222	No rewards on most cards
Online skill gaming	5816 (+ 7993, 7994 at SBI)	No rewards; fees: HDFC 1% > ₹10k/month, Axis 1% ≥ ₹10k/cycle, ICICI 2% all
Jewellery / gold	5944	Excluded on SBI Cashback, Flipkart SBI, Axis premium (gold), Amazon Pay ICICI
Gift cards / vouchers	5947, 5999, 5311 (varies by portal)	Earn only via official accelerated portals; Axis premium cards earn 0 from 28 Aug 2026; Flipkart SBI excludes vouchers
Grocery / departmental	5411, 5311	HDFC cap 2,000 / 1,000 RP per month; SBI ELITE/PRIME 5X–10X
Dining	5812, 5814	SBI ELITE/PRIME accelerated; HDFC DCB 2X weekends
Airlines / hotels / rail / bus	4511, 7011, 4112, 4131	Travel portals give the highest multipliers

2. Card table — 25 cards (5 issuers × 5)

Columns: base %, best category %, voucher route, caps, key exclusions, fee, grade.

HDFC Bank

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
Infinia / Infinia Metal	3.33% (5 RP/₹150 @ ₹1)	SmartBuy hotels 10X (33.3%), flights 5X (16.7%)	SmartBuy brand vouchers 5X (16.7%)	Voucher bonus 3,000 RP/month (from 1 Jul 2026); grocery 2,000, utilities 2,000, telecom 2,000, insurance 10,000 RP/month	Rent, fuel, govt, wallet, EMI, gaming, education via apps	₹12,500 + GST	OFFICIAL (SmartBuy 15282, MITC 31 Oct 2026)
Diners Club Black Metal	3.33% (5 RP/₹150 @ ₹1)	SmartBuy hotels/partners 10X (33%), flights/Myntra 5X (16.5%), weekend dining 2X	SmartBuy vouchers 3X (~10%)	Voucher bonus 3,000 RP/month; insurance 5,000 RP/month	As above + fuel	₹10,000 + GST	SECONDARY (cardadvisor) + OFFICIAL caps

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
Regalia Gold	1.25% (5 RP/₹200 @ ₹0.50)	Partner brands 25 RP/₹200 (6.25%); SmartBuy hotels 10X (12.5%), flights 5X (6.25%)	SmartBuy (multiplier not confirmed)	SmartBuy 4,000 RP/month; voucher bonus 3,000 RP/month; redemptions 50,000 RP/month	As Infinia	₹2,500 + GST	SECONDARY (base revised 15 May 2026)
Millennia	1% CashPoints	5% on 10 partner brands	Partner brands via PayZapp/SmartBuy drop to 1%	5% tier 1,000 CP/month; 1% tier 1,000 CP/month	Fuel, rent, EMI, wallet, govt	₹1,000 + GST	OFFICIAL T&C (20 Jul 2026) + SECONDARY
Tata Neu Infinity	1.5% NeuCoins	5% on Tata brands (+ up to 5% NeuPass)	Tata brand vouchers inside Tata Neu	Insurance via Neu 2,000 NeuCoins/month; non-Neu UPI 0.5% capped 500/month	Wallet, rent, fuel	₹1,499 + GST	SECONDARY

ICICI Bank

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
Emeralde Private Metal	~3% at ₹1/pt (6 RP/₹200); 1.2% as statement	iShop hotels 12X (36%), flights/vouchers 6X (18%)	iShop 6X vouchers (18%)	iShop bonus 18,000 pts; Amazon/ Flipkart vouchers ₹12,000/ month; education/grocery/utilities/insurance 1,000 pts per cycle (2026)	Rent, fuel, tax, govt	₹12,499	SECONDARY (iShop data early 2025 — stale)
Times Black	~0.8% domestic @ ₹0.40; ~1% intl	iShop 6X vouchers (12% per iShop table)	iShop 6X	iShop bonus 15,000 pts; shared 5,000 RP/cycle on utility, insurance, education, govt	Fuel, rent, EMI	₹20,000	SECONDARY
Sapphiro	~0.5% domestic; ~1% intl	iShop 6X (3%)	iShop 6X	iShop bonus 9,000 pts; utility ₹80k,	Fuel, rent, wallet	₹3,500	SECONDARY

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
				insurance ₹80k, grocery ₹40k per cycle; transport ₹20k/month (Feb 2026)			
Rubyx	~0.5% domestic; ~1% intl	iShop 6X (3%)	iShop 6X	Same as Sapphiro	Fuel, rent, wallet	₹2,000	SECONDARY
Amazon Pay ICICI	1%	5% Amazon (Prime), 3% non-Prime, 2% Amazon Pay partners	iShop co-brand 4% (cap ₹1,100)	—	Fuel, rent, EMI, education, tax, intl, gold/silver; utilities outside Amazon since 11 Oct 2025	Lifetime free	SECONDARY; gift-card treatment PENDING (terms PDF)

SBI Card

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
Cashback SBI	1% offline	5% on any online merchant	Online voucher purchase — check	5% leg ₹2,000/month (₹40k	Utility, insurance, fuel, rent,	₹999	SECONDARY

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
			exclusion list before use	spend); 1% leg ₹2,000/month; ₹48,000/year	wallet, education, jewellery, railways, EMI, gaming, toll, govt (Apr 2026)		
SimplyCLICK	0.25%	10X (2.5%) partner brands; 5X (1.25%) other online	—	none listed	none listed	₹499	SECONDARY
ELITE	0.5% (2 RP/₹100 @ ₹0.25)	5X (2.5%) dining, grocery, departmental	—	none listed	Metro, Reliance Market, Walmart excluded from grocery rate	₹4,999	SECONDARY
PRIME	0.5%	10X (2.5%) dining, grocery, departmental, movies	—	none listed	Same as ELITE	₹2,999	SECONDARY

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
AURUM	~1% (4 RP/₹100 @ ₹0.25)	none	Aurum portal: no accelerated voucher earn	none listed	Fuel, rent, govt, wallet (6540/6541), gaming (5816, 7993, 7994)	₹9,999	OFFICIAL (portal T&C)

Note: Flipkart SBI (1%; 7.5% Myntra; 5% Flipkart/Cleartrip; ₹4,000 per quarter per tier) excludes voucher purchases.

Axis Bank

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
Magnus	12 EDGE/₹200 (~1.2–2.4% at ₹0.20–0.40)	35 EDGE/₹200 above ₹1.5L monthly spend	**None — gift cards earn 0 from 28 Aug 2026**	5,00,000 pts/year; 1,00,000 to Group A	Rent, wallet, utilities, govt, EMI (Sep 2023); insurance, gold, fuel (Apr 2024); gift cards (Aug 2026)	₹12,500 + GST	OFFICIAL (MITC)

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
Atlas	2 EDGE Miles/₹100	5 Miles/₹100 travel (up to ₹2L/month)	—	1,50,000 Miles/year; 30,000 Group A	Not stated	₹5,000 + GST	SECONDARY (applications paused)
Select	10 EDGE/₹200 (~1% @ ₹0.20)	20/₹200 (~2%) retail on first ₹20k/month	**None — gift cards earn 0 from 28 Aug 2026**	20/₹200 only first ₹20k/month	Same list as Magnus	₹3,000 + GST	OFFICIAL (MITC exclusions)
Flipkart Axis	1%	5% Flipkart, Myntra, Cleartrip; 4% preferred merchants	—	not stated	PENDING	₹500	SECONDARY
Airtel Axis	1%	25% Airtel bills in Airtel Thanks; 10% other Thanks utilities	—	25% capped at 2× base earned in cycle (12 Apr 2026)	Active Airtel connection required	₹500	SECONDARY

Note: Axis ACE (5% Google Pay bills, 4% Swiggy/Zomato/Ola, 1.5% other) is closed to new applicants.

Kotak Mahindra Bank

Card	Base	Accelerated categories	Voucher route	Caps	Exclusions	Annual fee	Grade
White Reserve	~1.6–2.5% via milestones	not published	—	not published	not published	₹12,500	SECONDARY (incomplete)
Solitaire (invite)	3 Air Miles/₹100	10/₹100 Kotak Unbox flights & hotels	—	1,00,000 miles/cycle accelerated	Rent, wallet, fuel, utilities, insurance, education, EMI, intl	Nil while member	SECONDARY
Zen Signature	~0.83% (5/₹150 @ ₹0.25)	10/₹150 shopping (~1.67%)	—	6,500 pts per cycle	Wallet, fuel, rent, gaming, EMI	₹1,500	SECONDARY
Cashback+ Prime	0.5%	5% online grocery, food delivery, entertainment, auto dealers; 3% fuel	—	750 pts (₹750) per cycle across accelerated	Rent, wallet, utility, education, transport (from waiver)	₹750	SECONDARY
811 #DreamDifferent	2 pts/₹100 online, 1 offline (~0.4%)	—	—	—	Fuel, railway	Nil	SECONDARY

3. American Express India

Reward Multiplier brand links closed 30 Sep 2026. ShopWise e-vouchers still advertised at 5X.

Card	Base	Accelerated	Milestones	Exclusions	Fee	Status
Gold Charge	1 MR/₹50 (~1% @ ₹0.50)	ShopWise e-vouchers 5X (~5%)	1,000 MR monthly for six ₹1,000+ transactions	Utilities (conflicting info)	₹4,500 + GST	Applications paused
Platinum Travel	1 MR/₹50	—	From 10 Sep 2026: 10,000 MR at ₹4L; ₹20,000 Taj voucher at ₹7L	—	₹5,000 + GST	Applications paused
MRCC	1 MR/₹50	—	1,000 MR for four ₹1,500+ txns; 1,000 MR at ₹20k/month	Fuel, insurance, utilities	₹4,500 + GST	Applications paused
SmartEarn	1 MR/₹50	10X Flipkart, Uber, Myntra etc. (500/month); 10X EaseMyTrip, Zomato (500/mont	₹500 voucher at ₹1.2L, ₹1.8L, ₹2.4L	—	₹495	Applications paused

Card	Base	Accelerated	Milestones	Exclusions	Fee	Status
		h); 5X Amazon (250/month)				
Platinum Charge	1 MR/₹40	—	Welcome up to ₹60,000	not specified	₹66,000 + GST	Applications paused

Grade: SECONDARY (cardadvisor, LFAL).

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4. Wallet top-up structure

Bank fees on loading wallets by credit card

Bank	Fee	Threshold	MCC	Effective	Grade
HDFC	1% of month's wallet loads, max ₹4,999/month	> ₹10,000 per calendar month (PayZapp excluded)	6540	1 Jul 2025	OFFICIAL
ICICI	1%	> ₹5,000 per month (Amazon Pay, Paytm, MobiKwik, Freecharge, OlaMoney)	—	15 Jan 2026	SECONDARY
SBI	1% of each load	each load > ₹1,000	6540, 6541	1 Nov 2025	OFFICIAL
Axis	1%	cumulative ≥ ₹10,000 per	6540	20 Dec 2024	OFFICIAL

Bank	Fee	Threshold	MCC	Effective	Grade
		statement cycle			
Kotak	—	—	—	—	PENDING

All five banks give **no rewards** on wallet loads.

Regulatory limits (RBI PPI rules)

Wallet type	Limit	Status
Full-KYC PPI	₹2,00,000 outstanding balance	In force (RBI notification 12094); 2026 draft keeps ₹2 lakh with equal monthly debit cap, P2P ₹25,000/month
Small (min-KYC) PPI	₹10,000 balance	2026 draft
Gift PPI (e.g. Amazon Pay gift card)	₹10 to ₹10,000 per card, not reloadable, monthly redemption caps set by issuer	Amazon Pay terms (Pine Labs)

The 2026 PPI direction was a draft (comments closed 22 May 2026); confirm whether it has been finalised.

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5. International cards (gift-card relevant)

US cards from UpgradedPoints (8 Aug 2026). Amex US terms exclude "purchases of gift cards" from eligible purchases.

Card	Country	Where gift cards can earn	Rate	Cap	Fee	Gift-card caveat
Chase Ink Business Cash	US	Office supply stores	5%	$25,000/yr combined	$0	No exclusion stated

Card	Country	Where gift cards can earn	Rate	Cap	Fee	Gift-card caveat
U.S. Bank Cash+	US	Chosen 5% categories	5%	$2,000/quarter	$0	None stated
Huntington Voice Business	US	Rotating category incl. office supply	4%	$7,000/quarter	$0	None stated
Costco Anywhere Visa (Citi)	US	Costco in-store gift cards	2%	—	$0 + Costco membership	Explicitly earns
Amex Gold / Blue Cash Preferred / Everyday	US	Supermarkets	4x / 6% / 3%	$25k / $6k / $6k per year	$325 / $95 / $0	**Gift cards excluded** by Amex terms
Crypto.com Visa Private/Obsidian	EEA	Any eligible merchant (card terms prohibit buying crypto)	4.5% (token)	First US$5,000/month, then 1%	US$500k stake	Verified 4 Nov 2026
Revolut (RevPoints)	France, Poland (terms differ by country)	—	—	—	—	PENDING

Europe list: waiting for the user's card list.

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6. Agent rules

1. Rank only (card × official channel) pairs the user holds; never suggest an excluded MCC route.
2. Subtract each card's remaining monthly/cycle cap before showing %; reserve the cap while an order is open.
3. Apply per-transaction rounding (floor of spend ÷ unit).
4. Show "expected" until points post (SmartBuy: up to 90 working days).
5. Show source link + "checked on" date next to every number; block the number if the source is older than 30 days.
6. For wallet routes, add the bank fee and zero reward before ranking.

7. Open items

- Kotak wallet fee; Kotak White Reserve details.
- Confirm SECONDARY rows on official pages (priority: ICICI iShop 2026 terms, HDFC DCB/Regalia Gold voucher multipliers, Amazon Pay ICICI gift-card treatment).
- Europe card list.

Sources

- HDFC MITC (31 Oct 2026): https://www.hdfc.bank.in/content/dam/hdfcbankpws/in/en/personal-banking/discover-products/cards/credit-cards/personal-mitc/mitc-in-english.pdf
- HDFC SmartBuy offer 15282: https://offers.smartbuy.hdfc.bank.in/offer_details/smartbuy/15282
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- Axis MITC: https://www.axis.bank.in/docs/default-source/default-document-library/mitc-credit-cards.pdf
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- CardAdvisor HDFC / ICICI / SBI / Kotak / Amex pages and Axis ladder (Sep–Nov 2026)
- Finology, ICICI 2026 changes: https://select.finology.in/articles/credit-card/icici-bank-credit-card-changes-2026
- CardExpert, ICICI iShop: https://www.cardexpert.in/icici-bank-ishop/
- LiveFromALounge, HDFC voucher cap and Amex Reward Multiplier
- RBI PPI notification 12094; Business Today on 2026 draft

- Pine Labs Amazon Pay gift card terms
- UpgradedPoints, best cards for gift cards (8 Aug 2026)